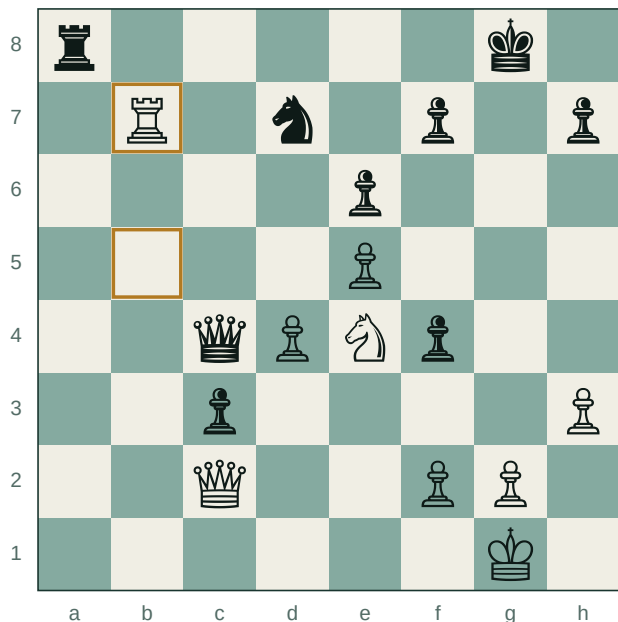


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 25

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Rb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Ra1+ 26. Rb1 Rxb1+ 27. Qxb1 c2

25...Ra1+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **26.Rb1**.

26...Rxb1+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on b1. Recorded reply: **27.Qxb1**.

27...c2 The pawn moves from c3 to c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on b7 and queen on c2. Check for tactical protection.